Seven Ways to Capture an Idea

Start with your own subject, action and setting. Then choose one camera sentence and its supporting details. No character sheet or reference image is required.

Fill in this table, then join the rows in order. Use one style at a time; do not stack incompatible camera instructions.

(for simple prompts)

Part	Your sentence
Camera	
Tone	
Lighting	
Texture	

Copyable structure

Camera
[Photographic style + lens, if useful + viewpoint + framing.]

Tone
[Mood + atmosphere. Subject + action + setting.]

Lighting
[Light source + direction + quality + effect on the subject and background.]

Texture
[Materials + visible surface details + interaction with movement or the environment + grain or noise, if appropriate.]

The examples below use one simple text-only scene so the capture choices are easy to compare. Replace that scene with your own idea. Our demo images used Nano Banana Pro and a costume reference for character consistency; your text-only result will differ.

For complex prompts :

Keep in mind the **CTLT** method but think like this
overall look → subjects → decor → finish

1. Close skate-camera

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

Camera:
Candid film photography shot close to the subject from knee height with a 12mm fisheye lens, wide framing, curved edges and a crooked horizon.

Tone:
Raw, spontaneous and slightly absurd. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and looking away from the camera.

Lighting:
Harsh direct on-camera flash lights the costume and nearby pavement, casting hard shadows behind the subject. Cool fluorescent light glows inside the laundromat while the street beyond remains dark.

Texture:
A real wearable costume with visible fabric and foam textures, creased denim, scuffed shoes, rough pavement and noticeable film grain.

2. Phone snapshot

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

*Set the aspect ratio to **9:16** in the image generator.

Camera:
Quick vertical phone snapshot taken at eye level while walking past, slightly tilted and loosely framed, with a little movement blur from the photographer's motion.

Tone:
Casual, fleeting and unposed. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and looking away from the camera.

Lighting:
Available fluorescent light spills from the laundromat onto one side of the costume. Weak street lighting leaves uneven illumination and noisy shadows around the subject.

Texture:
A real wearable costume with visible fabric and foam textures, folds in the cotton T-shirt, creased denim and phone-camera noise in the darker areas.

3. Intimate documentary

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

Camera:
Close handheld documentary photograph on 35mm film with a 35mm lens, taken at the seated subject's eye level, with waist-up framing and a slightly uneven crop.

Tone:
Quiet, observational and unguarded. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and turning their head away from the camera.

Lighting:
Uneven fluorescent light from the laundromat entrance falls across one side of the costume, fading into soft shadow on the other side. The background remains dim but visible.

Texture:
A real wearable costume with visible fabric seams and foam textures, folds around the elbows, grease marks on the fries carton and fine film grain.

4. Motion-blurred photo dump

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

Camera:
A badly shaken handheld phone snapshot with strong diagonal camera-shake blur across the whole image, doubled edges and smeared shapes. The subject remains recognizable, with blur affecting both the subject and background.

Tone:
Chaotic, accidental and slightly absurd. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and looking away from the camera.

Lighting:
Available fluorescent light from the laundromat and weak street lighting illuminate the scene. Bright areas smear into diagonal streaks in the same direction as the camera shake.

Texture:
Fabric, foam and denim read as soft blocks of texture, with coarse digital noise in the shadows and rough pavement smeared by the camera movement.

5. Low curbside

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

Camera:
Candid photograph shot from curb level with a 24mm wide-angle lens, full-body framing, shoes close to the camera, the oversized costume head farther back and pavement filling the foreground.

Tone:
Mundane, unposed and quietly comic. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and looking away from the camera.

Lighting:
Cool fluorescent light spills from the laundromat across the seated figure and curb. Weak street lighting catches the foreground pavement, with deeper shadows beneath the legs.

Texture:
A real wearable costume with visible fabric and foam textures, denim bunching around the knees, scuffed shoes and coarse pavement close to the lens.

6. Disposable Camera look

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

Camera:
Found footage flash photograph. Shot at night on a cheap digital point-and-shoot camera, with everything mostly in focus, a quick unplanned composition and an imperfect crop.

Tone:
Candid, mundane and slightly absurd. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and looking away from the camera.

Lighting:
Harsh built-in flash lights the costume from the front, casting a hard shadow behind it and clipping the brightest highlights. The laundromat glows faintly in the darker background.

Texture:
A real wearable costume with visible fabric and foam textures, creased denim, slightly crunchy digital detail, mild compression artifacts and noisy shadows.

7. Concealed observation

CTLT Structure

Camera → Tone → Lighting → Texture

Camera:
Telephoto photograph taken from inside a parked car, with compressed perspective and slightly soft focus. A blurred window edge and dashboard partially obscure the foreground.

Tone:
Quiet, distant and unposed. One person wearing a mascot costume with an oversized head and moustache, a black T-shirt and jeans sits on a laundromat doorstep at night, holding a carton of fries and looking away, unaware of the camera.

Lighting:
Available fluorescent light from the laundromat illuminates the subject across the street. The car interior stays dark, with weak street lighting falling unevenly across the surrounding pavement.

Texture:
A real wearable costume with fabric and foam textures, creased denim, rough pavement and visible grain, with faint reflections on the window glass.

Treat these phrases as directions, not exact camera settings. Inspect the result: did the viewpoint, framing, texture or blur actually change?